i. Were the policemen willing to leave the house?

j. What made the reporter gaze at the author?

About the Author



James Grover Thurber (1894–1961) was an American cartoonist, author, humourist, journalist, playwright, and celebrated wit. He was best known for his cartoons and short stories published mainly in The New Yorker magazine, such as "The Catbird Seat", and collected in his numerous books. He was one of the most popular humourists of his time, as he celebrated the comic frustrations and eccentricities of ordinary people.

Glossary

hullabaloo (v) - lot of loud noise made by people who are excited.

patrolman(n) - a patrolling police officer.

attic(n) - a space or room inside or partly inside the roof of a building

slammed(v) - shut a door or window forcefully and loudly.

gruffly(adv.) - sadly

intuitively(adv.) - without conscious reasoning, instinctively

whammed(v) - struck something forcefully

bevelled(v) - reduced to a slopping edge

rending(v) - tearing to pieces

yanked(v) - pulled with a jerk

zither(n) - a musical instrument consisting of a flat wooden sound box with numerous strings stretched across it, placed horizontally and played with fingers

guinea pig(n) - a domesticated tailless South American rodent originally raised for food

hysterical(adj.) - affected by wildly uncontrolled emotion

creaking(v) - making a squeaking sound when being moved

indignant(adj.) - feeling or showing anger or annoyance at what is perceived as unfair treatment

holster(n) – a holder made of leather for carrying handgun

rafter(n) - a beam forming part of the internal framework of a roof

deserter(n) - a person who leaves the armed force without permission.

A. Answer the following questions in a sentence or two.

VBP7W

1. Why was the narrator sorry to have paid attention to the footsteps?
2. Why did Herman and the author slam the doors?
3. What woke up the mother?
4. What do you understand by the mother's act of throwing the shoe?
5. Why do you think Mrs. Bodwell wanted to sell the house?

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